

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1558

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Overton Park in
Memphis on the occasion of its 125th
anniversary.

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee is proud of its natural beauty and scenic
landscapes, from the Great Smoky Mountains to the Mississippi River, including our wonderful
public parks; and

WHEREAS, one such sprawling public space is the iconic Overton Park, a 342-acre
public park in Midtown Memphis; named in honor of John Overton, a co-founder of Memphis,
Overton Park is celebrating its 125th anniversary this year; and

WHEREAS, the property that would become Overton Park was purchased by the City of
Memphis on November 14, 1901, and was located along the city's eastern and northern
boundary at the time; and

WHEREAS, storied landscape architect Georges Kessler was hired to plan the park that
same year, and Overton Park was officially opened to the public in 1906; and

WHEREAS, the grounds of Overton Park are home to the Brooks Museum of Art, the
Memphis Zoo, Overton Park Golf Course, Rainbow Lake, Veterans Plaza, the Levitt Shell, and
the Old Forest Arboretum, which boasts one of the few remaining old-growth forests in the State
of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Overton Park offers Memphians and visitors alike wonderful venues and
accessible green spaces where they can come together for reflection, inspiration, celebration,
and discovery while enjoying the green heart of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Overton Park offers playgrounds, picnic areas, trails, and other amenities
that make it a vibrant destination that has become one of the most treasured public spaces in
the South; and

WHEREAS, Overton Park is an enduring symbol of the natural beauty of our State, and it is most fitting that we pause to reflect on its important legacy and continued impact at this time; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we celebrate and honor a true Tennessee treasure, Overton Park, on the occasion of its 125th anniversary, a beautiful gift from our forebears that we will continue to cherish forever.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.